

ATTRACTION: Vishnupad Mandir

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Vishnupad Temple

LOCATION:

Banks of Phalgu river, Gaya

DISTRICT / REGION:

Gaya

CATEGORY:

Religious Site / Historical Site

OVERVIEW:

Vishnupad Mandir is an ancient Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Vishnu, located on the banks of the Phalgu river in Gaya. It is highly revered as the central site for Shradha rites in Hindu tradition. The temple is built over the legendary site where Lord Vishnu purportedly killed or pinned the demon Gayasura underground, leaving behind a 40-cm footprint incised into a basalt block called Dharmasila.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Located prominently along the Phalgu river, the Vishnupad temple's central attraction is a 40-cm footprint purported to be of Lord Vishnu. The footprint is incised into a block of basalt known as Dharmasila. The temple is crowned by a striking 50-kilo gold flag, which was donated by a devoted follower, Gayapal Panda Bal Govind Sen. Over the centuries, the shrine has been visited by many legendary saints, including Madhvacharya, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, and Vallabhacharya.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

The temple is a cornerstone of Hindu religious practices, serving as the primary center for Shradha rites in Gaya. The visits from eminent saints like Madhvacharya, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, and Vallabhacharya further highlight its historical and spiritual stature.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

According to Hindu mythology, Lord Vishnu killed the demon Gayasura by stepping on his chest and pinning him underground. The Dharmasila basalt block at the temple retains the 40-cm footprint left by Lord Vishnu during this act. It is also the traditional epicenter for performing Shradha rites to honor ancestors.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Features a 40-cm footprint of Lord Vishnu on the Dharmasila basalt block.
- A 50-kilo gold flag donated by Gayapal Panda Bal Govind Sen sits atop the temple.
- Believed to be the spot where Vishnu defeated the demon Gayasura.
- The central hub for Shradha rites for Hindus in Gaya.
- Visited by historical saints: Madhvacharya, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, and Vallabhacharya.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit: October to March

Opening Hours: 05:00AM - 10:00PM

Entry Fee: Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended: Not Mentioned

Photography: Videography & Photography Allowed

Accessibility Information: Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Parking, Restaurants, Drinking Water, Souvenir Shop

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport: Gaya International Airport (10 Kms)

Distance From Airport: 10 Kms

Nearest Railway Station: Gaya Junction (05 Kms)

Distance From Railway Station: 05 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand: Govt. Bus stand near Gandhi Maidan, Gaya (2.5 Kms)

Distance From Bus Stand: 2.5 Kms

Road Connectivity: Not Mentioned

Nearest Tourist Information Centre: Tourist Information Centre, Gaya Junction (05 Kms)

Nearest Police Station: Vishnupad Police Station (01 Km), Mob : 9431092838

Nearest Medical Facility: Jay Prakash Narayan Hospital, Gaya (Mob : 9470003263), Anugrah Narayan Magadh Medical Collage & Hospital, Gaya (Ph : 0631-221074)

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Mahabodhi Mandir & 80 feet Buddha state (17 Kms)
- Thai Temple (17 Kms)
- Ramshila (07 Kms)
- Pretshila (11 Km)
- Pita Maheshwar (02 Kms)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Center for Shradha rites for Hindus.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Souvenir Shop available

ACCOMMODATION:

- Vishnu View Hotel
- Ajatsatru Hotel
- Hotel Mantra Regency
- Hotel Royal View

HOTELS:

- Vishnu View Hotel (Mob: 9608556289)
- Ajatsatru Hotel (Mob: 9798881223)
- Hotel Mantra Regency (Mob: 9973357885)
- Hotel Royal View (Mob: 9431224222)

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Manoranjan Prasad Samdarshi (Mob: 9939999991)
- Niraj Kumar (Mob: 9431606061)
- Virendra Kumar (Mob: 9576745741)

- Nutesh Kumar (Mob: 9546842604)
- Brajesh Kumar (Mob: 9771081686)

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Gupta Tour & Travels (Mob: 8507192638)
- Vishal Tour & Travels (Mob: 9006169000)
- Maa Vaishnavi Tour & Travels (Mob: 8083329781)
- Surya Services (Mob: 9431094940)

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- The Dharmasila contains a 40-cm footprint of Lord Vishnu.
- The temple flag is made of 50 kilos of gold.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Vishnupad Mandir, located on the banks of the Phalgu river in Gaya, is an ancient Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Vishnu. Renowned as the center for Shradha rites, the site features a 40-cm footprint of Lord Vishnu on the Dharmasila basalt block and a 50-kilo gold flag. Located just 5 Kms from Gaya Junction and 10 Kms from Gaya Airport, the temple provides facilities like parking, restaurants, and souvenir shops. Nearby attractions include Ramshila, Pretshila, and the Mahabodhi Mandir.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is the Vishnupad temple famous for?

A: It is famous for a 40-cm footprint of Lord Vishnu incised into a basalt block called Dharmasila, and it is the central site for Shradha rites.

Q: What legendary saints have visited the Vishnupad Mandir?

A: Madhvacharya, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, and Vallabhacharya have visited the shrine.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located on the banks of the Phalgu river in Gaya.

Q: How can visitors reach the temple?

A: It is accessible via Gaya Junction (5 Kms away) and Gaya International Airport (10 Kms away).

Q: What are the nearby attractions?

A: Nearby attractions include Mahabodhi Mandir, Thai Temple, Ramshila, Pretshila, and Pita Maheshwar.

KEYWORDS:

Vishnupad Mandir, Vishnupad Temple, Gaya, Phalgu River, Lord Vishnu Footprint, Dharmasila, Gayasura, Shradha Rites, Hindu Pilgrimage, Bihar Tourism, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu